Travel and Expenses Policy

Harbour Health

Document control	
Version	3.1
Effective from	1 April 2026
Policy owner	Fatima Ali, Finance Officer
Approved by	Nina Osei, Operations Director
Applies to	All staff, bank staff and volunteers of Harbour Health
Questions	finance@harbourhealth.example

1. Purpose

This policy sets out which costs Harbour Health pays back when you spend money on Harbour business, the limits that apply, and how to claim. It covers travel between clinics, travel to training and meetings, accommodation, meals and small purchases made on behalf of Harbour.

If something is not covered here, ask your line manager before you spend the money. If your manager is unsure, they should ask the Finance team.

2. Principles

- Spend Harbour's money as carefully as you would spend your own.
- Choose the cheapest option that still gets the job done.
- Get approval before you book travel or a course, not after.
- Claim only what you actually spent, once, with the evidence this policy asks for.
- The limits below are maximums, not allowances. If you spend less, claim less.

3. Travel

3.1 Travel between clinics

Most business travel at Harbour is between our four Bristol clinics. Use the clinic pool car where one is free, or claim mileage for your own car. Bus fares between clinics are reimbursed with a ticket or a bank statement line.

3.2 Rail

Travel standard class. First class is not reimbursed. Book through the Finance team for any journey over £60 so we can use the railcard and advance fares.

3.3 Taxis

Taxis are reimbursed when you travel after 21:00, when you carry equipment or supplies between clinics, or when no reasonable public transport exists. Record the reason in the claim.

3.4 Using your own car

Mileage is paid at 45p a mile for the first 10,000 business miles in the tax year and 25p a mile after that. Travel between home and your base clinic is not business mileage. If you go from home to a clinic that is not your base, claim the extra distance only. Parking is reimbursed with a receipt. Fines are never reimbursed.

4. Limits

The limits apply per person, anywhere in the UK, including London.

Item	Limit
Meals and subsistence	£25 a day
Hotel, any UK city	£150 a night
Training courses and conferences	Pre-approved by your line manager and the Operations Director
Team meals	Not reimbursed
Home working equipment	Not reimbursed; ask IT for a loan item

4.1 Meals and subsistence

You can claim meals when you travel overnight on Harbour business, or when you attend training or a meeting away from your base clinic for more than 8 hours in a day. The daily limit covers breakfast, lunch, dinner and soft drinks. Alcohol is not reimbursed.

If breakfast is included in your hotel rate, the daily limit stays the same.

4.2 Hotels

Overnight stays need approval from the Operations Director before you book. The nightly limit covers the room and taxes. It does not cover the minibar, room service beyond the meals limit, films or late checkout.

5. Receipts

Keep an itemised receipt for every expense above £10. Upload a photo of it to the claim. For expenses of £10 or less, such as a bus fare, you can claim without a receipt, but you must enter the date and the business reason.

A card statement is not an itemised receipt. If you lose a receipt, complete the missing receipt form and ask your line manager to sign it.

6. Claiming and approval

1. Submit claims on the Harbour expenses form, saved next to this policy in the Policies folder, to finance@harbourhealth.example within 30 days of the date you spent the money.
2. Your line manager approves every claim.
3. A claim over £250 also needs approval from the Operations Director.
4. Approvers must not approve their own claims. Send those to the Operations Director, or to the Finance Officer if the claim is the Operations Director's.

Claims approved by the 10th of the month are paid with that month's salary. Claims approved after the 10th are paid the following month.

7. What is not reimbursed

- Travel between home and your base clinic
- Fines, penalties and parking tickets
- Upgrades to rail or hotels
- Travel or meals for partners, family or friends
- Alcohol
- Gifts for colleagues

- Lost or stolen personal items

8. Breaches

Claiming money you did not spend, claiming the same cost twice, or splitting a cost to get under an approval threshold is a disciplinary matter and may be treated as gross misconduct.

9. Contacts

- Expenses questions and claim status: Fatima Ali, Finance Officer, finance@harbourhealth.example
- Approval above £250 and overnight stays: Nina Osei, Operations Director